

משה רבינו starts off with the famous medrash of ברוך הוא listening to the 515 תפילות of אהרן and telling him to not daven anymore. We all know this מדרש, but before getting into the topic, I'd like to ask the following question, which is not well known: How many times did אהרן הכהן daven to go into ארץ ישראל? The answer is zero. He did not daven to go into ארץ ישראל. The מגלה עמוקות asks this question and points out that there's a פסוק in Parshas Matos (במדבר ל"ב:כ"ב) - וְהָיִיתֶם נְקִיִּים מִה' וּמִשְׁרָאֵל - We have to be blameless and spotless in the eyes of Hashem and ישראל.

An interesting observation made by R' Moshe Donnebaum in the Torah Anytimes is that כמעט no one is מקיים the pasuk because it's so hard to be both blameless in the eyes of Hashem and in the eyes of ישראל. אהרן הכהן was never recorded as having davened to Hashem to go into ארץ ישראל. Why? He was afraid that others might suspect him of having ulterior motives. As a כהן, he would receive the מתנות כהונה when he came into ארץ ישראל, and perhaps people would say that he was only davening to be allowed to enter ארץ ישראל so that he could get all the כהונה gifts. Since there was the possibility of having his intentions misunderstood, he didn't daven to enter ארץ ישראל so that he should be נקי, clear even from those who might mistakenly make an assumption.

משה רבינו's torrent of תפילות was answered. The answer was no. What is the important lesson to derive from this?

There is a מחלוקת in the גמרא as to when משה רבינו davened to Hashem to be allowed to enter into ארץ ישראל. Whichever שיטה we take, it happened before Hashem commanded משה רבינו to take נקמה from ישראל. We know that כלל ישראל refused to send out the soldiers because they knew of this הבטחה and they didn't want to be גורם his מיתה, as the פסוק says (31:5) וַיִּמָּסְרוּ, that they were given against their will.

The משנה says in פרקי אבות (ב"ט"ז) - לא עליך המלאכה לגמר: (ב"ט"ז) פרקי אבות - Your job is not to look at what ברוך הוא gives you as a task and say, "I've got to do it all", because we can't. Obviously, we can't, for so many reasons. However, in the ילקוט שמעוני it says you shouldn't say you can't do it because it's too much or too hard; one must do what one can. They bring a משל about this. There was once a king who had a palace with beautiful gardens surrounding. In the gardens a hole opened up. The king hired workers to fill in the hole. One of the workers, who was not terribly bright, said, "There's no way I'm going to start filling in this בור. It's too big. I'll never be able to finish it. Might as well not even try." The second worker said, "I know this בור is big, but I'm paid by the day. If I'm paid by the day, I'll do a day's work. I'll do what I can in one day, and if there's another day, I'll do another day. I'm מקבל upon myself to do the work for the time I am hired." The הקדוש ברוך הוא says to us: "What difference does it make to you if you complete the job? You are a day worker. Do what you can, and I will give you שכר for all that you do."

There's a מעשה שהיה that when the לב, בעל ייטב לב, R' Yekusiel Yehuda Teitelbaum (the father of R' Yoelish, the Satmer Rebbe of my youth) was an old man, he became quite ill and his family was desperate to help him. They wanted to get one of these famous doctors, one of the מומחים of the דור to come in to help him. In those days they called such an expert a professor. He told them, "I don't want you to bring me a professor." They asked "Why not?" He answered, "I'll tell you a story. R' Yoel Sirkis was the מחבר of a ספר called בית חדש. Many of you may not have heard of the words בית חדש, but if you look at the initials, בית חדש is the ב"ח. The ב"ח is one of the premiers מפרשים on שולחן ערוך. One time he came to visit his son-in-law, the טורי זהב. A bit more familiar name, he is the ט"ז. The ב"ח and the ט"ז have monumental מחלוקתים, father-in-law and son-in-law, but it doesn't matter, it was all לשם שמים. That is what counts. So he came to visit his son-in-law the ט"ז, and everyone from the city came out to greet him except one young man who was not interested. He didn't come to see him. The ט"ז asked him, "Why are you not coming to give a שלום עליכם to my father-in-law the ב"ח?" The young man answered, "אליהו הנביא came to me and told me that the ב"ח is in חרם in the מעלה של בית דין." The ט"ז asked why? The young man replied "One time the ב"ח was traveling, and he came across a town in which there was a תורה between two



people. A person had purchased a wagon load of lumber. The buyer said he had promised to pay three זהובים, three gold coins. However, the seller claimed that he had promised to give ten gold coins. They had this large מחלוקת, no one could resolve it. Since the ב"ח was there, they asked him to step in and give a psak. The ב"ח heard the מחלוקת and responded "It's an issue of 10 versus 3? Is that why you're stopping me on the road, to go and take time to do this? Not worth it."

At that moment, a קטרוג came out in שמים and they said he is going into חרם. Why? A famous הלכה that we know: דין פרוטה כדין מאה. There's no such thing by frum Yidden as a small claims court. The issue is the principle, not the amount. He was therefore punished for that. So the ט"ז asked the ב"ח, is that true? He said, "Yes, it actually did happen" and they realized that this אברך, this young man, was a שליח from שמים to rectify the situation. They were קובע a בית דין and took away the נידוי, they took away the חרם.

The ב"ח realized that this young man is no ordinary young man. He came over to him and said "I see that you are חשוב מאוד. I'd like you to do me a favor. I have here a manuscript of my ספר called בית חדש. Do me a favor and look it over, tell me what you think of it." He agreed and took the כתב יד. A number of days later the ב"ח returned and asked, "Have you looked at my ספר?" The אברך said "Yes, but I cannot return it to you. Your ספר is געוואלדיג, it is fabulous, but I know that if I give you back the ספר, you will die shortly thereafter. I don't want to be גורם that, so I want to hold back and delay giving you the ספר." The ב"ח replied, "If that's the reason why you won't give it back, I'm willing to give up my life and my נשמה to הקדוש ברוך הוא in order not to delay my ספר, because it is important for me to distribute it around the world." The אברך heard that and returned the ספר, and that's exactly what happened. Shortly after he got the ספר back and it was published, he passed away.

The ייטב לב said to the people around him, "I know my time is up. I know - I feel it. I did my עבודה in עולם הזה, and I don't want you to call this doctor because my days are limited and I realize that it is time for me to go. So I do not want to delay my going."

That is the relationship that משה רבינו had with הקדוש ברוך הוא. משה רבינו was given a צוואה: נקמת בני: צוואה. Moshe ran to do it, and he passed away shortly thereafter. What do we learn from this? A person has to understand his purpose in life. Our purpose in life is not to spend time down here. Our purpose in life is to do רצון השם.

משה רבינו davened to enter ארץ ישראל, not because of personal gain. He davened in ואתחנן because he wanted to do more מצוות. Hashem said, "You have fulfilled your תפקיד, you did my רצון, now is the time for you to go to עולם הבא." Once משה רבינו heard that, he immediately ran to do Hashem's will, whether it was by מדין, whether it was by not davening anymore, as well as his last מצוה, to go up on הר נבו and give up his נשמה.

This is the lesson that we get. No matter what our role in life is, our תפקיד is to do Hashem's רצון, each of us in our own way. If we do that, we will be זוכה to עולם הבא, and we'll be making the הקדוש ברוך הוא infinite.

